

Search Engine Optimization



Conduct an SEO Audit



Part One: Analysis of an Audit



Technical Review: Screaming Frog

Please answer the following questions.

1 *Does Screaming Frog successfully spider the website?*

Yes. Screaming Frog successfully spidered the Udacity website, crawling 500 URLs at 16 URLs/s and completing 100% of the crawl. All HTML pages returned a 200 OK status code, confirming the bot was not blocked by robots.txt or meta tags.

2 *Is the site developed with a clear information hierarchy; how so?*

Yes. The site has a clear information hierarchy. The Screaming Frog tree diagram shows www.udacity.com as the root, branching into logical sections such as school-of-ai, school-of-data-science, school-of-programming, blog, enterprise, and resources. Each school then links to its respective nanodegree and course pages.

3 *Is the content organized in a logical structure; how so?*

The content is organized logically, following a hub-and-spoke structure. The homepage links to schools, each school links to relevant nanodegrees, and individual course pages are nested beneath their program. However, the visual graph also reveals orphan and dead-end pages, indicating some content is not fully connected to the main hierarchy.



Technical Review: Core Web Vitals

Please answer the following questions.

1 *What factors are used to determine Core Web Vitals assessment?*

Core Web Vitals are measured using three factors: First Contentful Paint (FCP) - how quickly content first appears on screen; Largest Contentful Paint (LCP) - how quickly the largest visible element loads; and Cumulative Layout Shift (CLS) - how much the page layout unexpectedly shifts during loading.

2 *Which specific measurement is lacking (scoring poorly)?*

Mobile performance is the lacking area. The mobile Core Web Vitals assessment failed, with a performance score of only 49/100. The LCP of 2.6s and CLS of 0.13 are both in the "needs improvement" range.

3 *What are 3 things that could be done to improve CVW for Udacity.com?*

Three improvements: (1) Reduce unused JavaScript - PageSpeed identified 1.57s of savings from trimming unused JS bundles; (2) Properly size and compress images - 53 oversized images were flagged, with 0.81s potential savings; (3) Reduce third-party code impact - third-party scripts are blocking the main thread for 1.260ms and should be lazy-loaded or replaced with facades.

4 *What is the value of passing the Core Web Vitals test?*

Passing Core Web Vitals is a confirmed Google ranking signal. Sites that pass are eligible for a ranking boost in mobile search results. It also directly improves user experience, reducing bounce rate and increasing engagement.



Technical Review: SE Ranking and Ahrefs Pt 1

Please answer the following questions.

1 *Is the site being spidered and indexed by Google?*

Yes. Google has indexed 7,850 pages of Udacity.com according to the SE Ranking site audit. The Ahrefs crawl confirmed 4,872 indexable internal URLs out of 6,801 total internal pages crawled.

2 *How many pages are indexed in Bing?*

Only 29 pages are indexed in Bing, which is extremely low compared to 7,850 in Google. This suggests Udacity has not optimized for Bing Webmaster Tools and may be missing a significant secondary search audience.

3 *What is the Top Issue in SERanking?*

The top issue in SE Ranking is Duplicate Description, affecting 85 pages. This is a critical error because duplicate meta descriptions prevent Google from differentiating page content, reducing click-through rates from search results.

4 *What is the Top Issue in Ahrefs?*

The top issue in Ahrefs is HTTPS pages with internal links to HTTP (4,332 instances). This is a serious technical error that can cause mixed-content warnings, harm user trust, and create redirect chains that dilute link equity across the site.



Technical Review: SE Ranking and Ahrefs Pt 2

Please answer the following questions.

1 *What is the Health Score based on?*

Ahrefs calculates the Health Score based on the proportion of internal URLs that have no errors. A URL is considered healthy if it returns a 200 status code and has no critical crawl errors. With 4,987 URLs containing errors out of 11,312 total crawled URLs, Udacity scores 56/100.

2 *What kinds of URL errors are causing a poor health score?*

The primary URL errors dragging down the health score are: 224 pages returning 404 (Not Found) status, 224 additional 4XX error pages, 91 broken redirects, and 58 3XX redirect pages that are still receiving organic traffic. These all signal broken or inefficient URL structures to search engines.

3 *Explain the issue: "Duplicate pages without canonical"*

This error means two or more URLs serve essentially the same content, but none of them has a canonical tag telling Google which version is the authoritative one. Without a canonical, Google may split the ranking value between the duplicates, index the wrong version, or choose to ignore both. Udacity has 86 such pages, which can negatively impact crawl budget and keyword rankings.



On-Page Content Review: Screaming Frog

Please answer the following questions.

1 *How many on-page factors are duplicated?*

Multiple on-page factors are duplicated: 42 URLs share duplicate page titles, 2 URLs have duplicate meta descriptions (with 85 exact duplicates flagged in SE Ranking), and 21 pages have titles that are identical to their H1 tag. These duplications reduce each page's individual relevance signal.

2 *What is the advantage of Page Titles being less than 60 characters?*

Page titles under 60 characters display fully in Google search results without being truncated. Titles that are cut off lose context and reduce click-through rates. Out of 195 Udacity's pages crawled, 21 (10.77%) have titles over 60 characters, meaning they are being truncated in SERPS.

3 *Why are Meta-Descriptions important?*

Meta descriptions are the preview snippet displayed under a page title in search results. While not a direct ranking factor, well-written meta descriptions improve click-through rates by setting user expectations. They are also the primary place to include a call to action. Udacity has 27 pages missing meta descriptions entirely.

4 *Which on-page factors are missing?*

Missing on-page factors include: H1 tags (26 pages, 13.33%), H2 tags (21 pages, 10.77%), meta keywords (164 pages, 84.10%), and meta descriptions (27 pages, 13.85%). The most severe gap is missing meta keywords, which affects over 84% of all crawled pages.



On-Page Content Review: SE Ranking

Please answer the following questions.

1 *Which keywords are ranking in the top 10 in Google?*

2 keywords entered the top 10 during the tracked period: "python learning" and "python programming."

2 *How many keywords are ranking in positions 11-30?*

12 keywords rank in positions 11-30.

3 *Which keywords have the highest search volume?*

The highest search volume keywords are "learning python," "python learning," and "coding in python," each with 33.1K monthly searches.

4 *What are SERP features? Why are they important in the rankings?*

SERP features are special result formats Google displays beyond the standard 10 blue links, including Featured Snippets, Knowledge Panels, Video Carousels, People Also Ask boxes, and Image Packs. They are important because they often appear above organic results (position zero), generate significantly higher click-through rates, and can capture traffic even when a site doesn't rank #1. Udacity currently shows 0 SERP features for its tracked keywords, representing a major missed opportunity.

On-Page Content Review:

Website SEO Analysis Pt 1



In your understanding of SEO, how effective are these pages for the keyword “learning python?” Provide **at least 3 specific reasons** on your answer.

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1 | <p><i>Please write your #1 specific reason for effectiveness or lack of effectiveness here:</i></p> <p>The heading hierarchy is inverted and ineffective. The H1 tag correctly contains the course name (“Introduction to Python Programming”), but major content sections like “About this Course,” “Course Leads,” and “What You Will Learn” are marked as H4 tags instead of H2. Meanwhile, lesson titles use H2. This reversed structure confuses search engines about which content is most important on the page.</p> |
| 2 | <p><i>Please write your #2 specific reason for effectiveness or lack of effectiveness here:</i></p> <p>The page title and meta description are not optimized for the keyword “learning python”. The title is generic (“Free Intro to Python Course Udacity”) and the meta description does not prominently feature the target keyword phrase. Top-ranking competitors like learnpython.org and python.org use the exact keyword in both their title and description, giving them a relevance advantage.</p> |
| 3 | <p><i>Please write your #3 specific reason for effectiveness or lack of effectiveness here:</i></p> <p>The page has very thin textual content compared to top-ranking pages. With a word count of approximately 743 words and a text ratio of 4.59%, the page does not provide the depth of content that Google rewards for educational queries like “learning python.” Competing pages from w3schools, GeeksforGeeks, and programiz contain thousands of words of tutorial content, signaling much greater topical authority.</p> |

On-Page Content Review:

Website SEO Analysis Pt 2



Recommend at least 3 specific optimization steps for the course page, **Intro to Python Programming**. List on-page elements with examples along with your recommendations.

1 *What additional optimizations could increase rankings?*

Three specific optimization steps for the Intro to Python Programming page:

- (1) Fix the heading hierarchy - change "About this Course," "What You Will Learn," and "Course Leads" sections from H4 to H2, and nest lesson titles as H3. This correctly signals content priority to search engines.
- (2) Rewrite the page title to include the primary keyword: "Learn Python Programming Free - Introduction Course | Udacity" (under 60 characters, keyword-forward).
- (3) Expand on-page content significantly - add a dedicated "Why Learn Python" section with at least 500 words covering Python use cases, career outcomes, and prerequisite knowledge, making the page a more comprehensive resource that competes with GeeksforGeeks and w3schools for educational queries.

On-Page Content Review:

Website SEO Analysis Pt 3



Recommend at least 3 specific optimization steps for the course page, **AI Programming with Python**. List on-page elements with examples along with your recommendations.

1 *What additional optimizations could increase rankings?*

Three specific optimization steps for the AI Programming with Python nanodegree page:

- (1) Restructure headings - the H1 is correct ("AI Programming with Python"), but section headers like "What You Will Learn" use H4 instead of H2. Lesson modules use H4 as well. Restructure to H2 for major sections and H3 for sub-modules.
- (2) Add keyword-rich FAQs at the bottom of the page using FAQ schema markup. Queries like "what is AI programming with Python," "how long does it take to learn AI in Python," and "is Python good for AI" all have significant search volume and FAQ schema can trigger rich results.
- (3) Add student outcome data and testimonials as structured content - include real stats on graduate career outcomes (job placement rate, salary uplift) which increases trust signals, time-on-page, and provides keyword-rich unique content that differentiates the page from free tutorial sites.

Off-Page Content Review: Backlinks Pt 1



Please answer the following questions.

1 *What is the Udacity.com Domain Trust score?*

Udacity.com has a Domain Trust score of 90 out of 100, which is excellent.

2 *What is the total number of backlinks?*

The total number of backlinks to Udacity.com is 14.1M.

3 *How many domains are linking to Udacity.com?*

Udacity.com has 49.3K unique domains.

4 *How many links are dofollow?*

97.9% of all backlinks are dofollow, equating to approximately 13.76M dofollow links.

5 *How many links are nofollow?*

Only 2.1% of backlinks are nofollow, equating to approximately 294.61K nofollow links.

Off-Page Content Review:

Backlinks Pt 2



Please answer the following questions.

6

How many links are to the homepage?

Only 93 backlinks point directly to the Udacity homepage (0.1% of all links).

7

How many links are to other pages? Why is this desirable?

99,9K backlinks point to other internal pages (99.9% of all links).

8

What is the link trend over the past 12 months?

The referring domain trend over 12 months is consistently positive, growing from approximately 38K to 45K referring domains.

9

What do you learn from the Anchor Text report?

The anchor text report reveals a critical concern: 99.63% of all backlinks use the anchor text "APPLY NOW," representing 99,633 of the total links.



Competitive Analysis Pt 1

Please answer the following questions.

1 *Which of the competing websites has the most backlinks?*

Coursera.org has the most backlinks among the competitors, with 20,559,059 backlinks according to the SE Ranking competitor comparison.

2 *Which of the competing sites has the most referring domain links?*

Coursera.org has the most referring domains at 346,509.

3 *What are the Domain Trust rankings of the competing sites?*

Domain Trust rankings: Coursera 91, Udacity 90, Codecademy 90, GeeksforGeeks 89, Programiz 76.

4 *Analyze the competitor rankings for 'Learn Python' in both reports: Do the rankings lineup with backlinks factors? Where do factors not lineup to the rankings?*

The rankings do not fully lineup with backlink factors. Coursera dominates rankings and has the most referring domains (346K), which aligns. However, GeeksforGeeks outranks Udacity despite Udacity having more total backlinks (14.1M vs 5.1M).



Competitive Analysis Pt 2

Create a comparison chart of Udacity and its competitors to easily compare competitive factors.

	Domain Trust	Page Trust	Number of Referring Domains	Total Number of Links	Estimated Monthly Traffic
Udacity	90	21	49.3K	14.1M	195K
Code Academy	90	23	135.4K	10.2M	1.3M
Coursera	91	24	346.5K	20.6M	6.3M
Programiz	76	29	15.3K	214.4M	1.8M
Geeks For Geeks	89	38	74.1K	5.1M	5.6M



Part Two: Final Assessment and Presentation



Final Assessment: Audit Synthesis Pt 1

Please answer the following questions in complete sentences

1 *Please write a single sentence summary of your Audit findings.*

Udacity.com has strong domain authority (DT 90) and a healthy backlink profile, but is significantly underperforming in organic search rankings for Python-related keywords due to pervasive on-page SEO deficiencies, mobile Core Web Vitals failures, and thousands of unresolved technical errors that limit its crawlability and indexability.

2 *Highlight at least one area where the website is performing well.*

Udacity's backlink profile is a clear strength: with 14.1M total backlinks from 49.3K referring domains, a Domain Trust score of 90, 4.9K EDU links, and a 97.9% dofollow ratio, the site has an exceptional foundation of link authority that very few competitors can match.

3 *List 3 issues that are inhibiting the website's performance.*

- (1) Severe on-page errors - 189 pages missing meta descriptions, 263 pages missing H1 tags, 42 duplicate page titles, and inverted heading hierarchies on course pages all reduce relevance signals for target keywords.
- (2) Mobile Core Web Vitals failure - the mobile performance score of 49/100 with a failed assessment means Udacity is penalized in mobile search rankings, where the majority of educational searches now occur.
- (3) Massive technical debt - 4.332 HTTPS pages with internal HTTP links, 224 broken 404 pages, 86 duplicate pages without canonical tags, and a site health score of just 56/100 waste crawl budget and dilute the considerable link authority Udacity has built.



Final Assessment: Audit Synthesis Pt 2

Please answer the following questions in complete sentences

1 *Explain why the **first** issue inhibiting the website's performance needs to be corrected.*

The missing and duplicate on-page elements must be corrected because they are the most direct signal Google uses to understand what each page is about. When 189 pages lack meta descriptions and 263 pages have no H1 tag, Google cannot reliably match those pages to relevant search queries. This means Udacity is invisible for hundreds of potential keyword opportunities, directly costing enrollments on its core product pages.

2 *Explain why the **second** issue inhibiting the website's performance needs to be corrected.*

The mobile Core Web Vitals failure needs immediate correction because mobile-first indexing means Google primarily evaluates the mobile version of the site for all rankings. A performance score of 49 and a failed CLS assessment means Udacity is receiving a ranking penalty on mobile searches. Since over 60% of Python learning searches happen on mobile devices, this failure is actively costing Udacity rankings, traffic, and enrollments against competitors who pass mobile CWV.

3 *Explain why the **third** issue inhibiting the website's performance needs to be corrected.*

The 4,332 HTTPS-to-HTTP internal link errors and 224 broken pages must be resolved because they represent a massive drain on crawl budget and link equity. Every internal link to an HTTP URL creates an unnecessary redirect, wasting crawler resources and diluting the page rank flow that would otherwise strengthen Python course pages. The 224 broken pages mean external backlinks pointing to those URLs are delivering authority to dead ends. Fixing these issues allows Udacity's Domain Trust of 90 to fully benefit its most important ranking pages.



Final Assessment: Recommendations

List your Top 5 SEO Recommendations below with #1 being the recommendation with the greatest potential for positive impact on SEO.

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1 | <p><i>List your #1 SEO recommendation here</i></p> <p>Fix all on-page elements site-wide: add missing H1 tags (263 pages), write unique meta descriptions (189 missing pages), eliminate duplicate page titles (42 pages), and correct heading hierarchy on all course pages to properly signal keyword relevance to Google.</p> |
| 2 | <p><i>List your #2 SEO recommendation here</i></p> <p>Resolve mobile Core Web Vitals failures: reduce unused JavaScript (1.57s savings), properly size and compress images (0.81s savings), eliminate render-blocking third-party scripts (1.260ms main thread block), and enable text compression to reach a mobile performance score above 90.</p> |
| 3 | <p><i>List your #3 SEO recommendation here</i></p> <p>Fix all HTTPS-to-HTTP internal links (4.332 instances) and resolve 224 broken 404 pages to eliminate redirect chains, restore link equity flow to course pages, and improve the Ahrefs site health score from 56 to above 80.</p> |
| 4 | <p><i>List your #4 SEO recommendation here</i></p> <p>Implement a content expansion strategy for Python course pages: add 1.000+ words of educational content, FAQs with schema markup, student outcomes data, and structured curriculum information to compete with GeeksforGeeks and Programiz for high-volume informational Python queries.</p> |
| 5 | <p><i>List your #5 SEO recommendation here</i></p> <p>Build high-quality editorial backlinks with keyword-rich anchor text: the current profile shows 99.63% of links use generic "APPLY NOW" anchor text; a targeted outreach campaign to EdTech blogs, universities, and developer publications for branded and keyword-anchored links will strengthen rankings for "learning python" and related terms.</p> |



Presentation: Defend Recommendation 1

Defend your #1 SEO Recommendation. Explain the importance and potential impact of this recommendation with at a minimum of 5 sentences.

1 *Defend your #1 SEO Recommendation here.*

On-page SEO elements are the primary mechanism through which Google understands what a page is about and matches it to user queries. When 263 pages on Udacity.com have no H1 tag and 189 pages lack a meta description, Google must guess the topic of each page, which leads to poor keyword matching and low impressions in search results. Fixing H1 tags and meta descriptions is the highest-leverage action because it directly affects every page's ability to rank. The heading hierarchy issue on course pages is equally critical: using H4 for major sections like "About this Course" and "What You Will Learn" tells Google these sections are tertiary content, while competitors who correctly use H2 for these sections get a stronger relevance signal. The 42 pages with duplicate titles also mean Google is unsure which page to rank for a given query, so it may suppress both. Given that Udacity is already tracking 14 Python keywords with none in the top 5, these on-page fixes alone could move several keywords into the top 10, translating to thousands of additional monthly visitors. This recommendation requires no external resources and can be implemented entirely by Udacity's content team, making it both the highest-impact and lowest-cost action in this audit.



Presentation: Defend Recommendation 2

Defend your #2 SEO Recommendation. Explain the importance and potential impact of this recommendation with at a minimum of 5 sentences.

1 *Defend your #2 SEO Recommendation here.*

Google switched to mobile-first indexing for all websites, meaning it crawls and ranks pages primarily based on their mobile version. Udacity's mobile Core Web Vitals assessment is currently FAILED, with a performance score of 49/100 - well below the 90+ threshold for optimal performance. The CLS score of 0.13 indicates significant layout instability, and the LCP of 2.6 seconds is in the "needs improvement" range. Research consistently shows that a 1-second delay in mobile page load time reduces conversions by 20%, which for an enrollment-driven business like Udacity means lost revenue directly correlated to page speed. The three highest-impact fixes identified by PageSpeed Insights - reducing unused JavaScript (saves 1.57 seconds), properly sizing images (saves 0.81 seconds), and lazy-loading third-party code that blocks the main thread for 1.260ms - are all engineering-level changes with clear, measurable outcomes. Competitors like Coursera and GeeksforGeeks, which already rank above Udacity for Python keywords, both pass Core Web Vitals. Achieving a passing mobile score would remove a ranking penalty and put Udacity on equal footing with these competitors in mobile search results, where the majority of Python learning queries originate.



Presentation: Defend Recommendation 3

Defend your #3 SEO Recommendation. Explain the importance and potential impact of this recommendation with at a minimum of 5 sentences.

1 *Defend your #3 SEO Recommendation here.*

Udacity's Ahrefs site health score of 56/100 is primarily driven by two categories of technical errors that have a direct financial impact on rankings. The 4.332 HTTPS pages containing internal links to HTTP URLs create unnecessary redirect chains: every time Google follows one of these links, it must process an additional HTTP-to-HTTPS redirect before reaching the destination page. This wastes crawl budget, which is limited for any domain, meaning Google crawls fewer of Udacity's important course pages per day. The 224 broken 404 pages are equally damaging because any external backlinks pointing to these dead URLs are delivering domain authority to pages that return an error - that authority is completely wasted. Redirecting these 404 URLs to the most relevant live pages would immediately recover the ranking benefit of those backlinks. The 86 duplicate pages without canonical tags compound this problem by splitting ranking signals between multiple URLs for the same content. Together, these three issues mean that Udacity's exceptional Domain Trust score of 90 is not fully converting into page-level rankings because the link equity and crawl budget are being absorbed by broken and duplicate URLs rather than the Python course pages that need them most.



Presentation: Defend Recommendation 4

Defend your #4 SEO Recommendation. Explain the importance and potential impact of this recommendation with at a minimum of 5 sentences.

1 *Defend your #4 SEO Recommendation here.*

The data clearly shows that content depth is the primary reason Udacity is outranked by GeeksforGeeks, Programiz, and w3schools for Python keywords, despite having a higher Domain Trust score than all of them. GeeksforGeeks ranks top 11-19 positions with a DT of 89 versus Udacity's 90, and Programiz ranks in similar positions with a DT of only 76 and 71K backlinks versus Udacity's 14.1M. The difference is content: these sites provide thousands of words of free Python tutorials, code examples, and reference material that comprehensively serve informational search intent. Udacity's Python pages are course landing pages designed for conversion, not information delivery, so they rank poorly for informational queries like "learning python." Adding 1,000+ words of educational content to the Introduction to Python and AI Programming with Python pages, along with FAQ schema markup targeting common Python questions, would allow these pages to rank for the informational queries that feed the top of the enrollment funnel. FAQ schema in particular can trigger rich results in Google, giving Udacity a "position zero" appearance for questions like "how long does it take to learn Python" and "what is Python used for" - queries with significant monthly volume that competitors are currently capturing.



Presentation: Defend Recommendation 5

Defend your #5 SEO Recommendation. Explain the importance and potential impact of this recommendation with at a minimum of 5 sentences.

1 *Defend your #5 SEO Recommendation here.*

The backlink anchor text audit reveals that 99.63% of Udacity's 14.1M backlinks use the anchor text "APPLY NOW," which is a generic call-to-action with zero keyword value for Python-related rankings. While the sheer volume of these links contributes to the strong Domain Trust score of 90, they provide almost no keyword-specific ranking signal for terms like "learning python" or "python programming courses." Udacity should pursue a targeted link-building campaign aimed at three high-value sources:

- (1) EdTech and developer blogs that cover Python learning resources - offer guest posts or data-driven studies on Python career outcomes;
- (2) University career centers and CS department resource pages - Udacity's 4.9K EDU links are strong, but more can be earned by partnering with academic programs;
- (3) Industry publications covering AI, data science, and machine learning - pitch case studies of Udacity graduates to earn editorial links with relevant anchor text. Even earning 50-100 new editorial backlinks with keyword-rich anchors could meaningfully shift Udacity's rankings for high-volume Python terms where it currently sits in positions 15-25.



Standout Suggestions



Standout Suggestion #1: On-Page Comparison Part 1

Write a 1 paragraph assessment comparing the **On-Page factors** of the web pages listed on the previous slide in comparison to Udacity

1 *Write your 1 paragraph assessment here:*

Compared to the top-ranking pages for “learning python,” Udacity's Introduction to Python page is significantly weaker on every on-page dimension. Python.org's Getting Started page is authoritative, concise, and directly targets the query with keyword-rich H1 and H2 tags. Programiz.com's Python tutorial page contains thousands of words of inline code examples, step-by-step instructions, and topic-grouped navigation that fully satisfies informational search intent. GeeksforGeeks and w3schools offer encyclopedic reference content with breadcrumb navigation, internal linking to dozens of related Python topics, and user-generated content in comments - all signals of topical depth. Coursera's Python page, while a course listing like Udacity's, outranks it by including instructor credentials, syllabus details, learner reviews (social proof), and career outcome statistics. Udacity's Introduction to Python page, by contrast, is a minimal course card with a short description, lesson titles, and a CTA button. It has very few words of substantive content, no FAQ section, no user reviews on the page, and a broken heading hierarchy. To compete for this query, Udacity must transform its course page into a hybrid resource: part educational guide, part enrollment landing page.



Standout Suggestion #1: On-Page Comparison Part 2a

List and defend *in 1 to 3 sentences*, **3 on-page tactics** that Udacity could implement to increase rankings for the term, 'Learning Python'

1 *List your #1 On-Page tactic for Udacity improvement and your 1-3 sentence explanation here:*

Add a comprehensive "Why Learn Python" section (minimum 800 words) to the Introduction to Python course page, covering Python's real-world applications in data science, AI, automation, and web development, and explicitly mentioning the keyword phrase "learning python" in the first paragraph. This directly addresses the informational intent behind the query and provides the content depth needed to compete with tutorial-based pages that currently dominate the top 10.



Standout Suggestion #1: On-Page Comparison Part 2b

List and defend *in 1 to 3 sentences*, **3 on-page tactics** that Udacity could implement to increase rankings for the term, 'Learning Python'

1 *List your #2 On-Page tactic for Udacity improvement and your 1-3 sentence explanation here:*

Implement FAQ schema markup on the Python course pages with 5-7 common questions such as "How long does it take to learn Python?", "What can I do after learning Python?", and "Is Python free to learn?" These questions match high-volume "People Also Ask" queries that appear for "learning python" searches, and FAQ schema gives Udacity a chance to appear in rich result snippets above organic listings, dramatically increasing visibility without requiring higher keyword rankings.



Standout Suggestion #1: On-Page Comparison Part 2c

List and defend in 1 to 3 sentences, **3 on-page tactics** that Udacity could implement to increase rankings for the term, 'Learning Python'

1 *List your #3 On-Page tactic for Udacity improvement and your 1-3 sentence explanation here:*

Restructure the entire heading hierarchy on all Python-related course pages: replace H4 section headings with H2, nest lesson titles under H3, and ensure the page title and H1 both contain the phrase "learn python" or "learning python." This alone will significantly improve Google's ability to match the page to target queries because heading tags are a primary on-page relevance signal - and currently Udacity's headings are structured in reverse order of importance.



Standout Suggestion #1: Off-Page Comparison Part 1

Write a 1 paragraph assessment comparing the **Off-Page factors** of the web pages listed on the previous slide in comparison to Udacity

1 *Write your 1 paragraph assessment here:*

Udacity's off-page profile is paradoxically strong in volume but weak in quality for Python-specific rankings. With 14.1M total backlinks and a Domain Trust of 90, Udacity is technically competitive with Coursera (DT 91, 20.6M links) and well above GeeksforGeeks (DT 89, 5.1M links) and Programiz (DT 76, 214K links). However, Coursera's 346.5K referring domains versus Udacity's 49.3K shows that Coursera's links come from a far more diverse and authoritative set of sources. More critically, 99.63% of Udacity's links use the anchor "APPLY NOW," meaning Google sees almost no keyword-specific endorsement signal pointing to Udacity's Python pages. GeeksforGeeks and Programiz, despite having fewer total links, earn editorial links from developers, educators, and blogs using keyword-rich anchors that directly reinforce their relevance for Python queries. This explains why lower-authority domains outrank Udacity: link quality and keyword alignment matter more than link volume when the target keyword is informational in nature.



Standout Suggestion #1: Off-Page Comparison Part 2a

List and defend in 1 to 3 sentences, **3 specific tactics** that Udacity could implement to increase **high-value backlinks**.

1 *List your #1 Off-Page tactic for Udacity improvement and your 1-3 sentence explanation here:*

Launch a data-driven content outreach campaign: publish an original annual report on "Python Developer Salaries and Career Outcomes" based on Udacity graduate data, then pitch it to EdTech blogs, developer publications (e.g., Dev.to, Towards Data Science), and tech news sites. Reports of this type naturally earn editorial backlinks with keyword-rich anchors like "Python career guide" and "learn Python for data science," directly improving relevance signals for Udacity's target keywords.



Standout Suggestion #1: Off-Page Comparison Part 2b

List and defend in 1 to 3 sentences, **3 specific tactics** that Udacity could implement to increase **high-value backlinks**.

1 *List your #2 Off-Page tactic for Udacity improvement and your 1-3 sentence explanation here:*

Create a free, linkable Python resource page under udacity.com/python-resources that curates the best open-source Python tools, libraries, and learning paths. Free resource pages earn natural editorial links from blogs and educators who recommend tools to their audiences - a proven link-building tactic for EdTech sites. The page should be optimized with the anchor keywords Udacity needs (e.g., "learn python programming," "python for beginners") and actively promoted via Udacity's social channels and email list.



Standout Suggestion #1: Off-Page Comparison Part 2c

List and defend in 1 to 3 sentences, **3 specific tactics** that Udacity could implement to increase **high-value backlinks**.

- 1 *List your #3 Off-Page tactic for Udacity improvement and your 1-3 sentence explanation here:*

Partner with universities and bootcamps to earn high-authority .edu backlinks with keyword-relevant anchors. Udacity already has 4.9K EDU links, but most point to the admissions page. Propose formal curriculum partnership agreements with university CS departments where Udacity's Python courses are listed as supplementary resources on course syllabi pages - these generate .edu links with anchors like "Python programming course" and "introduction to Python" that carry exceptional authority and directly support rankings for the target keywords.